

I compared the price velocity of bull markets with bear markets and found price climbed twice as fast in bear markets as in bull ones. Downward breakouts show the same velocity: Bear markets see price fall twice as fast as in bull markets.

How many change trend? This is a count of how many patterns see price move more than 20% after the breakout. I like to see values above 50%, but the triangle falls well short of that in every column. Other chart patterns show better trending ability.

I think what's happening is that the symmetrical triangle is happy seeing price bounce up and down like a fishing bobber. Even after the breakout, price doesn't trend as well as other chart patterns as it continues to bob up and down.

[Table 66.3](#) shows failure rates for symmetrical triangles. For small declines, triangles with downward breakouts in bear markets have the lowest failure rates. After a maximum price rise of 10%, triangles with upward breakouts in bull markets show a smaller failure rate.

[Table 66.3](#) Cumulative Failure Rates

Maximum Price Rise or Decline (%)	Bull Market, Up Breakout	Bear Market, Up Breakout	Bull Market, Down Breakout	Bear Market, Down Breakout
5 (breakeven)	495 or 25%	92 or 23%	480 or 37%	85 or 19%
10	274 or 39%	78 or 43%	269 or 58%	76 or 37%
15	180 or 49%	44 or 54%	141 or 68%	60 or 50%
20	118 or 55%	42 or 65%	130 or 78%	47 or 61%
25	114 or 61%	27 or 72%	96 or 86%	50 or 72%
30	96 or 65%	23 or 78%	55 or 90%	29 or 79%
35	85 or 70%	17 or 82%	50 or 94%	17 or 83%
50	142 or 77%	37 or 91%	61 or 99%	56 or 95%
75	192 or 87%	16 or 95%	17 or 100%	21 or 100%
Over 75	254 or 100%	18 or 100%	1 or 100%	0 or 100%